IEGF Brand Style Guide

Informal Economy Global Forum — Visual Identity Reference

Generated from codebase on 26 March 2026 • For use when setting up Canva Brand Kit, templates, and marketing collateral

1. Brand Colours

These are the core brand colours. Use them consistently across all materials.

Primary Colours

Navy

Navy
HEX: #052A64
RGB: 5, 42, 100
Primary brand colour. Authority & trust. Used for headings, navigation, section backgrounds.

Green

Green
HEX: #4BA755
RGB: 75, 167, 85
Call-to-action colour. Growth & action. Used for primary buttons, accents, highlights.

Secondary / Neutral Colours

Light Grey

Light Grey
HEX: #D9D9D9
RGB: 217, 217, 217
Background panels, dividers, subtle borders.

Dark Grey

Dark Grey
HEX: #737373
RGB: 115, 115, 115
Body text, paragraphs, secondary information.

Off-White

Off-White (Background)
HEX: #F7F8FB
RGB: 247, 248, 251
Page background. Slightly warm white, avoids harsh pure white.

Utility Colours (sparingly)

Amber

Amber

HEX: #F59E0B

RGB: 245, 158, 11

Warnings, attention highlights. Use sparingly.

Red

Red

HEX: #EF4444

RGB: 239, 68, 68

Errors, critical alerts. Use sparingly.

2. Brand Gradients

These gradients add depth and visual interest. Use them for hero sections, accent strips, and icon containers.

Accent Gradient (Primary)

linear-gradient(135deg, #052A64 0%, #4BA755 100%)

Used for icon containers, nav underlines, decorative accents.

Hero Overlay

Navy overlay at varying opacities — applied over hero photography

Ensures text readability over background images.

Trust Strip (subtle)

Subtle off-white to light grey vertical fade

Used for statistics/trust-signal sections.

3. Typography

Montserrat — Primary (and only) Typeface

Source: Google Fonts • License: SIL Open Font License

Regular 400 — Body text, paragraphs, descriptions

The Informal Economy Global Forum empowers communities across Africa through structured development, skills training, and grassroots economic inclusion.

Semi-Bold 600 — Buttons, labels, overlines, navigation

Get Involved • Learn More • Partner With Us • Join a Task Force

Bold 700 — Headings, titles, statistics

Empowering Africa's Informal Economy

Type Scale (Website)

Page Title (H1)

3rem / 48px • Bold 700 • Navy or White (on dark backgrounds)

Section Heading (H2)

2.25rem / 36px • Bold 700 • Navy • tracking-tight

Card / Subsection Title (H3)

1.25rem / 20px • Bold 700 • Navy

SECTION OVERLINE / LABEL

0.875rem / 14px • Semi-Bold 600 • Green • Uppercase • tracking-wide

Body text and paragraphs use this size and weight for comfortable reading at any screen width.

0.95rem / ~15px • Regular 400 • Dark Grey (#737373)

4. Buttons

All buttons use Montserrat Semi-Bold 600, rounded corners (8px), and include hover + focus states.

Primary CTA (Green)

Get Involved

Learn More

Background: Green (#4BA755) • Text: White • Hover: slight opacity reduction + lift

Secondary CTA (Navy Outline)

Speak to Our Team

Download Report

Border: 2px Navy (#052A64) • Text: Navy • Hover: fills Navy, text turns White

Navy Solid Button

Join a Task Force

Background: Navy (#052A64) • Text: White • Used as secondary emphasis on light backgrounds

White Outline (on dark backgrounds)

Partner With Us

Border: 2px White • Text: White • Hover: fills White, text turns Navy • Used on Navy/dark hero sections

Focus States

All interactive elements show a **Green (#4BA755)** focus ring (2px, 2px offset) for accessibility.

5. Cards

Cards are the primary content container across the site.

M

Membership

Join a growing network of informal economy stakeholders across Africa.

Learn More

Card Specs

- **Background:** White
- **Border radius:** 16px (rounded-2xl)
- **Padding:** 32px
- **Shadow (rest):** 0 8px 28px rgba(5,42,100, 0.10)
- **Shadow (hover):** 0 16px 40px rgba(5,42,100, 0.14)
- **Hover effect:** translateY(-6px) lift
- **Icon container:** 56x56px, 16px radius, Navy-to-Green gradient background

6. Spacing & Layout

Content Width

Maximum content width: **1152px** (max-w-6xl), centred with auto margins and 16px horizontal padding.

Common Spacing Values

4px (1 unit)

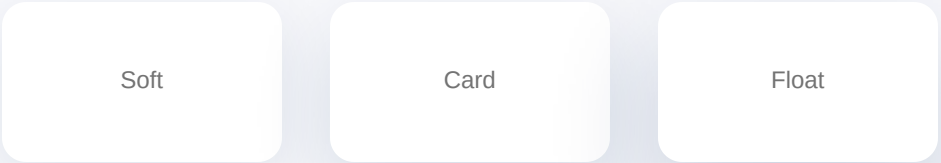
8px (2 units)

16px (4 units)

Breakpoints

- **Mobile-first** — base styles target small screens
- **md:** 768px — tablet and up
- **lg:** 1024px — desktop and up

7. Shadows



- **Soft:** `0 8px 28px rgba(5,42,100, 0.10)` — default resting state
- **Card:** `0 16px 40px rgba(5,42,100, 0.14)` — hover / elevated
- **Float:** `0 24px 55px rgba(5,42,100, 0.20)` — modals, dropdowns

Note: All shadows use Navy as the base colour (not black), giving them a warmer, branded feel.

8. Animation & Motion

- **Duration (fast):** 180ms — button clicks, micro-interactions
- **Duration (base):** 320ms — card hovers, transitions
- **Easing:** `cubic-bezier(0.22, 1, 0.36, 1)` — premium, slightly bouncy deceleration
- **Hover lift:** Cards lift 6px, buttons lift 2px
- **Reduced motion:** All animations and transitions are disabled when user prefers reduced motion

9. Logo NEEDED

The logo is currently a text placeholder ("IEGF"). The following versions are needed for the brand kit:

Primary Logo

Primary Logo

Full colour on white/light backgrounds. Navy + Green.

Reversed Logo

Reversed (White)

All-white version for Navy/dark backgrounds and hero overlays.

Icon Mark

Icon / Favicon

Square mark for favicons, app icons, social avatars. Sizes: 32px, 192px, 512px.

Monochrome

Monochrome

Single-colour version (Navy or Black) for print, fax, stamps.

Logo Specifications

- **File formats needed:** SVG (primary), PNG (with transparency), ICO (favicon)
- **Clear space:** Minimum padding equal to the height of the logo mark on all sides
- **Minimum size:** Define a minimum width below which the logo should not be displayed
- **Placement:** Currently top-left in the site header, height ~40px
- **Favicon sizes:** 32x32 (favicon-32.png), 192x192 (favicon-192.png), 180x180 (apple-touch-icon.png)

10. Brand Voice NEEDED

Brand voice defines how IEGF communicates in writing. This should be configured in Canva's Brand Voice feature so all team content stays consistent.

Tone Attributes (Recommended)

Empowering

We uplift and enable. Focus on what communities *can* achieve, not what they lack.

Inclusive

Accessible language. Avoid jargon. Speak to informal economy workers directly, not about them.

Professional

Credible and trustworthy. We're an organisation that partners with governments and institutions.

Action-Oriented

Direct, clear CTAs. "Join us", "Get involved", "Partner with us" — not passive language.

Key Terminology

"Informal economy" — not "informal sector" (economy is broader and more accurate)

"Workers" or **"participants"** — not "beneficiaries" (agency, not charity)

"People-centred" — core descriptor, hyphenated, used consistently

"Grassroots" — used for community-level work and the GIC programme

"Structured development" — IEGF's approach to formalising pathways

Still Needed

Approved tagline / strapline for use across materials

Elevator pitch (30-second description for bios, about sections, social profiles)

Boilerplate paragraph for press releases and formal documents

List of words/phrases to avoid

11. Photography NEEDED

The site currently uses placeholder gradients. The following photo categories are needed:

Hero Image

Hero / Banner Images

Wide-format (16:9 or wider). African communities, markets, enterprise. Min 1920x1080px.

Team Photos

Team Portraits

Consistent style, neutral background. Square crop (1:1). Min 600x600px.

Event Photos

Event Photography

Conferences, workshops, community events. Candid and staged. Min 1200x800px.

Impact Photos

Impact / Story Images

Real people, real outcomes. For case studies, testimonials, news articles.

Photo Guidelines for Canva

- **Style:** Warm, natural lighting. Authentic (not stock-looking). People in context.
- **Overlay:** Hero images get the Navy gradient overlay (see Section 2) for text readability
- **Colour treatment:** Slight warmth. Avoid cold/blue-tinted photography that clashes with Navy.
- **Formats:** WebP for web (with JPEG fallback), full-res JPEG/PNG for print
- **Optimisation:** Run through TinyPNG before adding to the website

12. Graphics & Patterns NEEDED

Decorative elements that reinforce the brand identity across materials.

Gradient

Accent Gradient

Pattern

Brand Pattern

Shapes

Decorative Shapes

Navy-to-Green diagonal. Used for icon containers, dividers, decorative strips. HAVE

Repeatable geometric or organic pattern for backgrounds, envelopes, packaging. NEEDED

Abstract shapes or African-inspired motifs for section breaks and slide backgrounds. NEEDED

Textures

Background Textures

Subtle textures for cards, headers, or print materials. Complements Off-White. NEEDED

13. Icon Set HAVE

The website uses an SVG icon sprite (`assets/icons.svg`). These should be uploaded to Canva as individual graphics for use in templates.

Current Icon Specs

- **Format:** SVG sprite with individual symbol IDs
- **Style:** Outline/stroke icons (not filled), `currentColor` for colour inheritance
- **Sizes used on site:** 24x24 (small), 28x28 (nav/cards), 64x64 (feature icons)
- **Viewbox:** 0 0 24 24

For Canva Upload

- Export each icon as an individual SVG file
- Upload to Canva Brand Kit under "Graphics" → "Icons"
- Provide both Navy and White versions for flexibility
- Consider adding filled variants for social media use

14. Templates NEEDED

Canva templates ensure consistent branded output across all communications. Create these in Canva using the brand kit colours, fonts, and logo.

Social Media Templates

Facebook / LinkedIn post — 1200x630px. Quote cards, event announcements, impact stats

Instagram post — 1080x1080px. Photo + text overlay, carousel slides

Instagram / Facebook Story — 1080x1920px. Event promos, behind-the-scenes

X (Twitter) post — 1200x675px. News highlights, link previews

LinkedIn banner — 1584x396px. Company page cover

YouTube thumbnail — 1280x720px. Webinar and video thumbnails

Email Templates

Email header banner — 600x200px. Newsletter and announcement headers

Email signature banner — 600x100px. Staff email signatures

Event Templates

Event banner — 1920x1080px. Conference, webinar, and workshop promotions

Event flyer — A4 / Letter. Print-ready event announcements

Name badge — Standard badge size. Conference attendee badges

Certificate — A4 landscape. Training completion, membership certificates

Web Graphics Templates

OG image — 1200x630px. Default social preview for each page

News article thumbnail — 800x450px. Media releases and news items

Partner logo card — 300x200px. Consistent partner/sponsor display

15. Document Templates NEEDED

Professional documents for internal and external use.

Letterhead — A4. Logo top-left, contact details in footer. Navy header accent strip.

Presentation deck — 16:9. Title slide, content slide, section divider, closing slide. Navy/Green gradient accents.

Report cover — A4. Annual reports, research papers, policy documents.

One-pager / Fact sheet — A4. Programme overviews, partnership proposals.

Invoice / Receipt — A4. Membership fees, event registration.

Meeting agenda — A4. Task force meetings, board meetings.

Business card — 90x55mm. Staff and board member cards.

16. Video & Motion NEEDED

Branded motion graphics for video content and presentations.

Video intro — 3-5 seconds. Logo animation with Navy-to-Green gradient sweep. For webinars, YouTube videos.

Video outro — 5-8 seconds. Logo + website URL + social handles. CTA to get involved.

Lower third — Speaker name/title overlay for webinars and interviews. Navy bar with white text.

Animated social post — Short looping animations for social media (stats, quotes, announcements).

Webinar holding screen — "Starting soon" / "We'll be right back" screens with brand styling.

Motion Guidelines

- **Easing:** Match the website — `cubic-bezier(0.22, 1, 0.36, 1)` for smooth deceleration
- **Transitions:** Fade and slide, no harsh cuts. Elements should feel like they flow in.
- **Colour in motion:** Navy-to-Green gradient sweeps are the signature brand animation
- **Duration:** Keep intros/outros under 5 seconds to respect viewer time

17. Do's and Don'ts

Do

- Use Navy for headings and authority
- Use Green for primary CTAs and action
- Use Dark Grey for body text
- Maintain high contrast for accessibility
- Use the Navy-to-Green gradient for accents
- Keep Montserrat as the only typeface

Don't

- Don't use Navy and Green at equal visual weight — one should dominate
- Don't use pure black (#000) for text — use Dark Grey or Navy
- Don't use Amber or Red for decorative purposes — only for system states
- Don't mix other typefaces with Montserrat
- Don't place light text on Light Grey backgrounds
- Don't use the gradient as a text colour

18. Canva Brand Kit Quick-Setup Checklist

Use this checklist when configuring the IEGF Brand Kit in your Canva account:

Colours to Add

Name	HEX	Role

Navy	#052A64	Primary
Green	#4BA755	CTA / Accent
Light Grey	#D9D9D9	Background
Dark Grey	#737373	Body text
Off-White	#F7F8FB	Page background
White	#FFFFFF	Cards / containers

Font to Add

- **Montserrat** (available in Canva's font library)
- Set as **Heading font**: Montserrat Bold (700)
- Set as **Subheading font**: Montserrat Semi-Bold (600)
- Set as **Body font**: Montserrat Regular (400)

Logo

- Upload logo once finalised (currently text placeholder "IEGF")
- Upload both dark-background (white text) and light-background (navy text) versions
- Upload square icon mark for social avatars and favicons

Brand Voice

- Set tone to: Empowering, Inclusive, Professional, Action-Oriented
- Add key terminology list (see Section 10)
- Add tagline and boilerplate when finalised

Photos

- Upload hero images, team portraits, event photos, and impact photography
- Tag by category for easy discovery in Canva

Graphics

- Upload individual icon SVGs from the icon sprite
- Create and upload brand pattern, decorative shapes, and background textures

Templates to Create

- Social media: Facebook/LinkedIn, Instagram, Stories, X, YouTube thumbnail
- Email: header banner, signature banner
- Events: banners, flyers, name badges, certificates
- Documents: letterhead, presentation deck, report cover, one-pager, business card
- Video: intro, outro, lower thirds, holding screens

19. Brand Kit Completeness

At-a-glance status of every brand kit category:

Category	Status	Notes
Colours	HAVE	6 brand colours + 2 utility colours defined
Gradients	HAVE	3 gradients defined with CSS values
Fonts	HAVE	Montserrat 400/600/700
Logo	NEEDED	Currently text placeholder. Need 4 versions.
Brand Voice	NEEDED	Tone attributes drafted, tagline + boilerplate needed
Photography	NEEDED	Hero, team, event, impact photos all needed
Graphics & Patterns	NEEDED	Have gradient. Need pattern, shapes, textures.
Icons	HAVE	SVG sprite exists. Need individual exports for Canva.
Social Media Templates	NEEDED	6 template types identified
Email Templates	NEEDED	Header banner + email signature
Event Templates	NEEDED	Banners, flyers, badges, certificates
Document Templates	NEEDED	Letterhead, presentations, reports, business cards
Video & Motion	NEEDED	Intro, outro, lower thirds, holding screens

20. Summary Table

Element	Specification
Primary Colour	Navy #052A64
Accent Colour	Green #4BA755
Body Text	Dark Grey #737373
Typeface	Montserrat (400, 600, 700)
Border Radius (buttons)	8px
Border Radius (cards)	16px
Max Content Width	1152px
Shadow Colour Base	rgba(5, 42, 100, 0.10–0.20)
Animation Easing	cubic-bezier(0.22, 1, 0.36, 1)
Gradient (accent)	135deg, Navy → Green

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